Storm Ismail

Junior Full Stack Developer | 3D & Interactive Web

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PROFILE

Junior full-stack developer with three years at the UWC Innovation Hub, where I went from AR/VR intern to Analyst Programmer leading a team of six on client projects including the Robben Island Museum. I recently completed Zaio's Full Stack Web Development bootcamp, building and deploying a full-stack booking platform (React, Node.js, Express, MongoDB) and an AI document assistant (Python, FastAPI, RAG). A degree in 3D animation and hands-on Three.js and Unity work let me bring interactive, visual experiences to the web.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Frontend:** JavaScript (ES6+), React, HTML5, CSS3, responsive design
- **Backend & APIs:** Node.js, Express, REST APIs, JWT authentication, Python, FastAPI
- **Databases:** MongoDB, Firebase Firestore, PostgreSQL (basic), data modelling
- **AI:** RAG pipelines, embeddings, FAISS vector search, Ollama
- **3D & Interactive:** Three.js / React Three Fiber, Unity, Twinmotion, Blender, 3D scanning and optimisation, AR/VR
- **Tools:** Git/GitHub, Vite, Render, Vercel, Cloudinary, n8n

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Analyst Programmer · UWC Innovation Hub Apr 2024 – Jun 2026

- Promoted from intern to lead a team of 6, owning project delivery, task allocation and day-to-day coordination, and working directly with stakeholders on requirements and implementation.
- Robben Island Museum VR experience (heritage site with over 300,000 visitors a year):
  - Photographed Jetty 1, where prisoners were held before the ferry to the island, with standard and 360° captures; built 3D scans from them, then optimised and placed the models in Twinmotion to present the scene layout to the client.
  - Co-designed the experience flow and storyboarded each gameplay section: the tasks users complete to unlock archival media (video, images, audio).
  - Edited and synced audio and video clips to match the story's flow, and designed and built the 3D coin reward unlocked on task completion.
  - Ran multi-headset demo sessions with the museum's CEO and team at the Waterfront, gathering feedback and catching bugs.
- Managed the content pipeline across client projects, from modelling and texturing through to in-engine integration in Unity.
- Provided technical support, troubleshooting and maintenance for all AR/VR systems at the Hub, and ran training sessions and outreach initiatives.

AR/VR Intern · UWC Innovation Hub Apr 2023 – Apr 2024

- Worked with the development team on immersive software projects and contributed to research on AR applications in higher education.
- Set up, configured and maintained AR/VR hardware and software systems.
- Delivered AR/VR training to students and staff using JigSpace, explaining technical tools to non-technical audiences.

PROJECTS

Booking Platform (Airbnb-style) – Capstone airbnb-frontend-9obn.onrender.com

Stack: React, Node.js, Express, MongoDB, JWT, Cloudinary

- Built a full-stack booking platform where guests search, view and book listings, and hosts create, edit and manage their listings and reservations.
- Designed a REST API with JWT authentication, bcrypt password hashing and role-based access for guests, hosts and admins.
- Found and fixed authorisation flaws after launch: restricted listing edits to their owners and blocked users from assigning themselves admin rights.
- Moved image uploads to Cloudinary and deployed the frontend and API separately on Render, using environment variables for configuration.

Handbook Assistant (RAG) github.com/Stormzy-webdev/RAG-System

Stack: Python, FastAPI, FAISS, sentence-transformers, Ollama

- Built an AI assistant that answers questions from a PDF handbook, returning only grounded answers with a page citation, and saying so when the answer isn't there.
- Implemented the pipeline end to end: PDF chunking, embeddings, FAISS vector search and a FastAPI endpoint with input validation and JSON error handling.
- Improved accuracy by fixing incorrect page citations, tuning retrieval depth and setting deterministic model output; covered the API with automated tests.

Interactive 3D Portfolio Website portfolio-website-six-sigma-80.vercel.app

Stack: React, Three.js (React Three Fiber), Vite, Blender, Web Audio API

- Built an interactive 3D portfolio from my own Blender models, with animated camera navigation, in-scene project screens and screen-recorded demos.
- Cut 3D asset size from about 52MB to 2.7MB and added a lightweight 2D version for phones and quick viewing.
- Deployed on Vercel with analytics.

Online Store

Stack: HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, Firebase Firestore

- Built an e-commerce store with product listings, a shopping cart and real-time data persistence via Firestore, with cart logic in vanilla JavaScript.

EDUCATION

Full Stack Web Development Bootcamp (part-time) · Zaio Institute of Technology Feb 2026 – Aug 2026

- Project-based training in JavaScript, React, Node.js, Express.js, REST APIs, MongoDB, Firebase, Git/GitHub and responsive web development.

Bachelor of Applied Arts in 3D Animation · STADIO Higher Education May 2019 – May 2022

- 3D modelling, animation, digital design and interactive media production.

Unity Learn: Create With Code

- Unity fundamentals and C# scripting basics, completed while at the UWC Innovation Hub.

ADDITIONAL

- **Languages:** English (fluent), Afrikaans (fluent)
- **References:** available on request